

1943, January 29

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original
by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M.Cap.

(may be the first draft)

SAINT FELIX MONASTERY

HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

January 29th - Feast of St. Francis de Sales

1943

Mr. James M. Casey
Seattle, Washington

My dear Brother:-

God bless you and yours. I hope you continue improving in body, mind and spirit, as last report from Mildred recently indicates you've been doing. Thanks be to God. How grateful we ought to be you and I that we are still "among the living"; still pilgrims able to merit for eternity, trying to follow thither at least in sight of the dearly deserving, Divine Master. We, I say, because while it is something that at all event and everywhere as rational creatures men should do, you and I have special cause for thanking the Good God this year.

I hardly need remind you of the marrow escapes you have had during the last ten months. Perhaps I ought rather refer to your threatening experiences and conditions as somehow pitched battles and, by the grace of God your victories; since you persevere in the Holy Faith. But I too had quite an experience in similar direction beginning last September about the 10th, with a severe case of "flue", together with a sort of vericose condition of ankle. While a number of my friends, both in the Hospital and outside seem to have considered my case "a close call to pneumonia, etc, I never felt that there was any immediate danger of collapse. Thanks be to God. To me it seemed about ten days of the really severest penance that the poor sinner Solanus had ever done and, therefore, since by God's grace he lived through it without complaint we have every reason to thank Heaven for the wonderful experience. Deo Gratias.

Now dear James:- since I received a hopeful letter from Fr. M. Joachim a few days ago, indicating a decided change in his attitude - a yearning to come back to the Monastery; and while you are still with us and able to appreciate, as I trust you will my little efforts, I am starting a conclusion to the description started before Fr. M.J. got sick; of Fr. Ed'wd's Jubilee and on that occasion our trip to "The Bluff" and old Trimbelle. Besides; while I find plenty of work to do here, nothing is so urgent that I cannot let it go till another day, for a sort of a double purpose; viz, to afford you a little entertainment and myself a form of recreation.